Future of Demographic Data Archives: Cooperation, Specialization, and Change

Lisa Neidert
Population Studies Center
University of Michigan

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Agents of Change

- **Technology**

  Distributed computing
  Internet
  Computing technology [CPU, Storage]
  Software

- **Funding Mechanisms**

  NICHD
  http://grants2.nih.gov/grants/guide/rfa-files/RFA-HD-00-011.html
  http://www.nichd.nih.gov/about/cpr/dbs/pubs/report.pdf

Demographic Data Cooperative - Home Page - Microsoft Internet Explorer

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Demographic Data Cooperative

The Demographic Data Cooperative is a collaboration of the **Inter-University Consortium for Political and Social Research** (ICPSR) and two leading demographic research centers: the **Minnesota Population Center** (MPC) and the University of Michigan **Population Studies Center** (PSC). Our goal is to increase the depth and breadth of demographic data available to researchers by pooling our archival holdings, taking advantage of complementary expertise at our centers, and exploiting new metadata standards and automatic data extraction software.

Funding provided by:

NATIONAL INSTITUTES OF HEALTH

Work Plan Overview

Archival Development

Metadata Improvement

Web-based Dissemination

Schedule

Goals and Work Plan

Schedule

We are now in the process of defining the scope and structure of the Demographic Data Cooperative by shaping the formal structure for cooperation among current and future partners and by developing a plan for archival development. In addition to planning, however, we want to make an immediate contribution to improving data access and encouraging collaboration among population researchers. Therefore, our first goals are to produce an integrated catalog of population center holdings and to design a website to allow seamless access to holdings across collaborating centers. During the coming year, we will begin work on the longer-term goals of the Cooperative: developing an on-line guide to demographic data, creating machine-understandable documentation, and developing metadata browsers and extraction tools.

Long-Term plans:

- Produce a comprehensive inventory of data resources at existing demographic data libraries
- Design a long-range plan for data acquisition and preservation
- Develop procedures for dissemination of restricted access files
- Conversion of paper documentation to electronic format
- Create machine-understandable (DDI compliant) metadata for key datasets
- Produce on-line guides to demographic data
- Make data and documentation freely available through direct download whenever possible
- Build metadata-driven extraction, tabulation, and browsing tools for demographic data

CESSDA Integrated Data Catalogue - Microsoft Internet Explorer

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C E S S D A

Integrated Data Catalogue

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Archives to search:

(Click archive names for local catalogues.)

- [ ] BDSP, France
- [ ] DDA, Denmark
- [x] DA, UK
- NSD, Norway
- [ ] SSD, Sweden
- [ ] SSDA, Israel
- [ ] Steinmetz, Netherlands
- [ ] TARKI, Hungary
- [ ] ZA, Germany
- [ ] ICPSR, USA

Query specification:

Title:

Names:

Contents:

Start year: End year:

Geographical focus:

Query options:

Connect fields with: AND

Verbose list: NO

Max. no. of hits: 40

Start search | Reset query

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Done Internet

Challenges of All Centers Catalog

- Dissemination Restrictions
- Cataloging Rules
- Documenting Differences
- Transfers Updates

Specialization

- Tradition role of demographic data archives
- Niches, expertise
- Ownership

Guides to Data

- Few exist for demographic data
- Distributed expertise, niches
- Responsibility of data producer
- Need for balance, critiques
- Substantive and technical issues
- Template for guides

Future

- Embrace change
  - Partner, cooperate, continue to learn
- Automation, technology will continue to impact access
- Confidentiality will be an issue for access
  - Represent voice of users
  - Negotiate access conditions

Future (continued)

- With easier access, user support becomes more critical
  - What do users need?
  - User education
- Respond to [changing] needs of users